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DEFENDANT STATEMENT — Daniel Reyes

Case #: 26-014872 **Declarant:** Daniel REYES, age 34 **Taken by:** Det. R. Salas #207 **Present:** Counsel for Mr. Reyes **Date:** March 15, 2026, 0245 hrs **Format:** Q&A, summarized verbatim (Miranda advised and waived for this statement)

Q: Tell me what happened tonight.

A: I came in after work like I do. I was having a drink at the bar. This guy — I didn't really know him — started running his mouth at me. I tried to let it go. I'm not looking for trouble. I've got a license, I carry, I don't go around starting things.

Q: How did it escalate?

A: He kept at it and got up in my space. We ended up back toward the pool table. He was bigger than me and he was drunk and angry. Then he just came at me. Fast. He reached down toward his waist and I saw something — I thought he had a knife or a gun. I really thought he was going to kill me.

Q: What did you do?

A: I didn't have time to think. He was right there, coming at me. I fired. Twice, I think. It was a reaction. I wasn't standing there planning anything — there was no time. One second he's coming at me reaching for his waist, the next it happened.

Q: How far away was he when you fired?

A: Not right on top of me, but close. A few steps. He was closing the gap. I'm not good with distances but he was coming at me, that part I'm sure of.

Q: Did you go toward him after?

A: No. No way. I backed off. I was shaking. I told Dana to call 911. I stayed right there. I didn't run. I didn't touch anything.

Q: Did you see a weapon on him?

A: I saw him reach and I saw something. They tell me there was a knife by him. In the moment all I knew was he was reaching and coming at me and I was scared for my life.

Statement read back and affirmed by declarant.